MIL-P-44131A
30 March 1987
SUPERSEDING
MIL-P-44131
25 June 1984

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PORK STEAK, FLAKED, FORMED, BREADED, FROZEN

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers frozen, breaded pork steaks that are flaked and formed.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

* 2.1.1 Documents. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-1163	- Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin, Impregnated

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8905

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications for Fresh Pork, Series 400

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Livestock and Seed Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC.

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Traffic Department, 2200 Mill Road, Alexandria, VA 22314.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

* 3.2.1 Pork. Pork shall be derived from any one or any combination of the following recognizable wholesale cuts: shoulders, shoulder picnics, hams, and loins. Recognizable cuts are those which, when compared to Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications (IMPS) cuts, have no more than a minor amount of lean, fat, or bone removed or included from an adjacent cut. The pork shall be in the fresh-chilled state and shall be in excellent condition, i.e., exposed lean and fat surfaces shall be of a color and bloom normally associated with the class and cut of meat and typical of meat which has been properly stored and handled. Cut surfaces and naturally exposed lean surfaces shall show no more than slight darkening or discoloration due to dehydration, aging, or microbial activity. The fat shall show no more than a slight discoloration due to oxidation or microbial activity. No odors foreign to fresh meat shall be present. Changes in color and odor characteristically associated with vacuum packaged meat in excellent condition shall be acceptable. The pork shall show no evidence of freezing, defrosting, or mishandling. Coarse-textured, dark pork, or pale, soft and exudative (PSE) pork is not acceptable. Cuts which have had a slight amount of lean fully removed will be acceptable. Cuts which have had more than a slight amount of lean removed, for any reason, shall not be included. All suitable lean meat shall be used in proportions as existing in the involved cut, except that the tenderloins may be excluded at the option of the contractor.

* 3.2.1.1 Boning and trimming. Pork shall be made boneless and trimmed to comply with the limitations listed in tables I and II. Pork shall be trimmed of fat to a degree necessary to assure compliance with finished product fat requirements (see 3.3.6). All pork shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) certificate to certify condition of the product and compliance with boning and trimming requirements.

* 3.2.1.2 Handling and storage. Handling and storage of the boned and trimmed pork, prior to further processing into the finished product, shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Pork processed on the day of initial certification shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 50°F, inclusive.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

b. Holding in the fresh-chilled state for not more than 4 days after certification is permitted, provided that the pork is maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F, inclusive.

3.2.2 Coating ingredients. Only commercially prepared coating ingredients (not artificially colored) commonly used for the type of product specified shall be permitted. This shall be determined by the manufacturer's label.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

* 3.3.1 Flaking. Boned and trimmed meat which meets the requirements of 3.2.1.1 shall be further trimmed as necessary and in such a manner so as to assure compliance with finished product requirements (see 3.4). The boned and trimmed pork shall be flaked, through an Urschel Comitrol Comminutor Model 2100, equipped with a size 3J030750 or 3J060750 head or equivalent flake cutting device.

3.3.2 Mixing. The flaked pork shall be thoroughly mixed mechanically. Mixing shall continue until the pork becomes moderately sticky.

* 3.3.3 Stuffing, freezing, and tempering. The flake-cut and mixed meat shall be mechanically stuffed into casings and shall be placed into a freezer within 4 hours after stuffing. Upon reaching a uniform temperature of 28°F or below throughout the logs, they may then be removed from the freezer for tempering and slicing. However, if kept in the freezer for 72 hours or longer, the internal temperature of the logs must reach 0°F or below within the initial 72 hour period. The time period during which the logs may be held in the frozen state, prior to tempering for forming and slicing, shall not exceed 10 days. The frozen meat logs shall be tempered to a temperature not to exceed 28°F prior to forming and slicing. Once removed from the freezer for tempering, the logs shall be formed and slicing initiated within 24 hours. Logs shall not be frozen and tempered more than once.

3.3.4 Forming. The tempered meat shall be removed from the casings and pressed or formed in a hydraulic meat press (not less than 500 psi) to provide a shape as shown in figure 1. Patty making equipment is not acceptable.

3.3.5 Slicing. The formed logs shall be sliced into uniform steaks each of which shall be not less than 0.4 inch nor more than 0.6 inch in thickness. In addition, the sliced steaks shall show no evidence of freezer burn or dehydration in excess of 0.5 square inch.

3.3.6 Fat content. The average fat content of the unbreaded steaks shall be not greater than 20.0 percent, and the fat content of any individual sample unit shall be not greater than 24.0 percent.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.7 Coating. Breading and batter shall be applied by machine so that each steak is completely coated on all surfaces. Breading may be applied by hand to correct periodic mechanical errors. Used breading may be sifted, when necessary, to clean containers for use the same day. Any unused batter or breading in the machine at the end of the day's run shall be discarded. Combined breading and batter shall not exceed 30 percent by weight of the breaded steak. The breading shall be applied in such a manner that the weight of the breaded steak shall be not less than 5 ounces nor more than 6 ounces. The temperature of the batter during breading shall not exceed 50°F.

* 3.3.8 Handling and storage during processing. Handling and storage of the flaked meat shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. The temperature of the flaked pork immediately following flaking shall not exceed 40°F. The temperature of the flaked pork at any other time during preparation and processing up to and including placement in the freezer shall not exceed 40°F. Use of dry ice is permitted to maintain temperature, but the pork shall not be allowed to freeze.

b. The flaking, mixing, stuffing, and placement in the freezer shall be a continuous process completed in one workshift.

c. The steaks shall be breaded, packed, and placed in the freezer within 4 hours after completion of slicing.

d. The tempering, forming, slicing, coating, packing, and placement in the freezer shall be a continuous process and, except for tempering, shall be completed within one working day.

3.3.9 Freezing and frozen storage. After the steaks have been packed and placed in the freezer, the following storage conditions shall be met:

a. The product shall be frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or lower within 72 hours after placement in the freezer.

b. The product shall be held at a uniform temperature of 0°F or colder.

c. The product shall be in excellent condition and the internal product temperature shall not exceed 0°F at time of shipment and delivery.

d. There shall be no evidence of thawing or refreezing at any time.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

* 3.4 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no extraneous material such as, but not limited to, casings, string, or wrapping paper.

c. The breading shall possess a typical fresh odor and a commercially prepared natural color.

d. The steak shall not be separated into two or more distinct pieces.

e. There shall be no coating ridges longer than 0.5 inch.

f. There shall be no lumps of coating on the surface of the steak greater than 0.3 inch in thickness.

g. There shall be no area on the top and bottom surfaces devoid of breading/batter 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.

h. There shall be not more than two areas on the top and bottom surfaces devoid of breading/batter 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.

i. Weight of breaded steak shall be not more than 6 ounces nor less than 5 ounces.

j. There shall be no evidence of freezer burn or dehydration 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.

* 3.4.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.5 Plant qualification. The pork component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Pork examination for condition and cut. All pork shall be examined in either the bone-in or boneless state for conformance to the condition and cut requirements in 3.2.1. Cuts initially examined in the boneless state shall be in the form of whole boneless recognizable cuts. Any nonconforming pork shall be rejected.

* 4.5.1.2 Boned and trimmed pork examination. After boning and trimming and prior to any further processing or to any freezing, the pork shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size expressed in terms of pounds shall be declared to the AMS agent by the contractor. However, the AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot a portion of a declared lot, if, in his or her opinion, that portion may be out of compliance with any requirement. The sample unit shall be a minimum of 12 pounds of adjacent boneless pork.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The sample size shall be as specified in table I. If all or a portion of the sample unit falls within a larger cut, the entire cut shall be examined. Failure of the pork to meet the acceptance criteria as indicated in table I shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Except for pork rejected because of freezing, defrosting, or not being in excellent condition, the pork may be reworked by the contractor and reoffered for examination. For reexamination, the sampling plan used shall be the one in table I designed for the next larger lot size than the one under which the lot was initially rejected. Pork shall not be reexamined more than one time.

TABLE I. Sampling plan for boned and trimmed pork

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size (No. of sample units)	Defect categories			
		Major		Minor	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
500 or less	20	2	3	5	6
501 to 1,200	32	3	4	7	8
1,201 to 3,200	50	5	6	10	11
3,201 to 10,000	80	7	8	14	15
10,001 to 38,000	125	10	11	21	22
Reinspection lots of 10,001 to 38,000	200	14	15	21	22

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed pork defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Presence of blood clot measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed pork defects 1/ 2/ - Continued

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
	201	Presence of blood clot measuring 0.3 inch or more but less than 0.5 inch in any dimension
102		Presence of bruise measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension
	202	Presence of bruise measuring 0.3 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension
103		Presence of bone measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
104		Presence of cartilage measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension
	203	Presence of cartilage measuring 0.3 inch or more but less than 0.5 inch in any dimension
105		Presence of popliteal, prescapular, prefemoral, or any exposed lymph gland measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension
106		Presence of skin measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
107		Exposed (protruding) ligaments and tendons measuring more than 0.3 inch
108		Presence of kidney measuring more than 1.0 inch in any dimension
	204	Presence of shank with tendinous end showing less than 75 percent lean tissue on a cross-sectional cut surface
	205	Presence of exposed blood vessel measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed pork defects 1/ 2/ - Continued

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
	206	Presence of skirt (diaphragm) or abdominal tissue
	207	Presence of leaf, lumbar, or pelvic fat
	208	Presence of mediastinal tissue in the first rib or sternal region
	209	Presence of dehydrated surface measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension

1/ Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal) or extraneous material (e.g., casing, string, wrapping paper) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.

2/ Evidence of freezing or defrosting or product not in excellent condition shall cause rejection of the lot.

* 4.5.1.3 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, handling, packing, and freezing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

* 4.5.3 Unbreaded steak examination. The sample size shall be as specified in table III. The unbreaded steaks shall be examined for the defects listed in table IV.

TABLE III. Sampling plan for unbreaded steak examination

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size (No. of steaks)	Defect categories			
		Major		Minor	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
1,200 or less	32	1	2	2	3
1,201 to 3,200	50	2	3	3	4
3,201 to 10,000	80	3	4	5	6
10,001 to 38,000	125	5	6	7	8
Reinspection lots of 10,001 to 38,000	200	7	8	10	11

TABLE IV. Unbreaded steak defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Evidence of freezer burn or dehydration 0.5 inch or more in any dimension

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Unbreaded steak defects 1/ - Continued

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
	201	Thickness at any point is less than 0.4 inch or more than 0.6 inch 2/
	202	Shape does not approximate that shown in figure 1

1/ Presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ In the event of a tapering side, the minimum thickness measurement will be made 0.2 inch from the outer edge.

4.5.4 Fat content testing. The fat content of the steak, prior to breading, shall be determined in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Meat and Meat Products, section: Meat. The lot size shall not exceed one day's production. The sample unit shall be three adjacent steaks. The sample shall consist of four sample units selected at random from the lot. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat requirements in 3.3.6 shall be classified as major and be cause for rejection of the lot.

* 4.5.5 Coating content examination. The coating content of the product shall be determined using the method in 4.5.5.1 or 4.5.5.2, as applicable. The sample size shall be 32 unbreaded or breaded steaks, as applicable. The lot shall be rejected if three or more steaks exceed the 30 percent by weight coating requirement.

* 4.5.5.1 In-process method. Each unbreaded steak shall be weighed, the weight recorded, and the steak returned to the belt. After being coated, the steak shall be removed and reweighed to determine percent coating. The percent coating shall be calculated to the nearest 1 percent using the following formula:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

$$\text{Percent coating} = \frac{\text{Weight of breaded steak} - \text{Weight of unbreaded steak}}{\text{Weight of breaded steak}} \times 100$$

* 4.5.5.2 Washing method. Procedure is as follows:

a. Weigh frozen breaded steaks and record each weight.

b. Place each steak in a water bath, maintained at 63° to 86°F (room temperature) during the test method, until such time as the coating becomes soft and can be easily removed from the still frozen steak. Remove the coating material by lightly rubbing the coated steak with fingers or by using a spatula and nut picker, as applicable, and being careful not to damage the steak. Place the decoated steak on a 1/2 inch mesh sieve over a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve and pour the contents of the container onto them. Remove the top sieve and drain at a 45 degree angle for 2 minutes, and then transfer contents to a balance. Rinse contents of the No. 20 sieve, collect any particles of meat and add them to the contents on the balance and weigh. Alternatively, the above method shall be used utilizing tap water, adjusted to a flow rate of approximately 3 quarts per minute through an aerated faucet spray head. The removal of the coating shall be done over the stacked 1/2 inch mesh and No. 20 sieves.

c. Calculate the percent coating as follows:

$$\text{Percent coating} = \frac{(A - B)}{A} \times 100$$

where A = weight of coated steak
B = weight of flesh collected on both sieves.

* 4.5.6 Breaded steak examination. The sample size and acceptance criteria shall be as specified in table V. The breaded steaks shall be examined for the defects listed in table VI.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE V. Sampling plan for breaded steak examination

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size (No. of steaks)	Defect categories			
		Major		Minor	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
1,200 or less	32	1	2	2	3
1,201 to 3,200	50	2	3	3	4
3,201 to 10,000	80	3	4	5	6
10,000 to 38,000	125	5	6	7	8
Reinspection lots of 10,001 to 38,000	200	7	8	10	11

TABLE VI. Breaded steak defects 1/ 2/ 3/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Breading lacks a typical fresh odor (e.g., stale odor)
102		Breading lacks a typical commercially prepared natural color
103		Steak separated into two or more distinct pieces
104		Steak weight more than 6 ounces or less than 5 ounces
	201	Presence of any area on the top and bottom surfaces devoid of breading/batter 0.5 inch or more in any dimension 3/

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VI. Breaded steak defects 1/ 2/ 3/ - Continued

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
	202	Presence of more than two areas on the top and bottom surfaces devoid of breading/batter measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
	203	Presence of coating ridges (excess breading which projects at the edge of the frozen steaks) longer than 0.5 inch
	204	Presence of lumps of coating on the surface of a steak greater than 0.3 inch in thickness

1/ Presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ Bare spots are breaks in the coating through which the pork steak is plainly visible.

4.5.7 Product frozen storage examination. Examination shall be made to determine conformance to the frozen storage requirements in 3.3.9. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

* 4.5.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Major

National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Net weight less than marked on container.
Not snug-fitting or evidence of bulging.
Polyethylene bag liner missing.
Polyethylene bag insufficient in size.
Polyethylene sheet missing or not placed as specified.
Tear or hole in polyethylene bag.
Layer thicker than one steak.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.

Minor

Other required markings, missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Weight of contents exceeds 55 pounds.
Polyethylene bag not folded as specified.
Arrangement not as specified.

Level C shipping containers shall be examined for the closure method specified in 5.1.2 and for the defects specified above, except for the reinforcement defect.

* 4.5.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level B. Not more than 55 pounds of steaks shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, grade W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636. The box shall be reinforced with one lengthwise band and one girthwise band of nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the steaks shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 200 of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with a hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band of nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color that contrasts with black. Prior to packing, the shipping container shall be lined with a polyethylene bag. The bag shall be of sufficient size

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

to line the interior surface of the box completely and shall overlap not less than 5 inches along the center of the longer axis after the bag is folded down over the packed portions. The steaks shall be arranged in layers, with each layer no thicker than the thickness of one steak. The layers of steaks shall be separated by a single sheet of polyethylene, not less than 1 inch longer than the length and width of the container. In addition, a sheet of polyethylene shall be placed between the bottom of the bag and the first layer and on top of the last layer packed in the box.

5.1.2 Level C. Not more than 55 pounds of steaks, arranged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container which complies with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable, except that closure of the fiberboard boxes shall be as specified in method II of the appendix of PPP-B-636. Prior to packing, each shipping container shall be lined with a polyethylene bag and the steaks arranged and separated with polyethylene sheets as specified in 5.1.1.

* 5.2 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.1.1 and 5.1.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

* 5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. In addition, the following precautionary marking placed on the top of each container in capital letters, larger than other markings, shall be included:

KEEP FROZEN (0°F or BELOW)

5.3.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article sample is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.4.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of packing required (see 5.1).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article. When a first article sample is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Other processes. Manufacturing processes and procedures which differ from those specified herein may be used provided the product manufactured therefrom is equivalent in composition and texture to that manufactured under the process procedures outlined in the preceding paragraphs. Alternative manufacturing processes must be approved and details provided to USDA by the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center prior to use. For this purpose, twenty-five (25) pork steaks should be sent to the following address together with completed details of the alternative process with which the pork steaks were fabricated:

U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center
Food Engineering Laboratory
Food Technology Division
Animal Products Group
Natick, MA 01760-5014

* 6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Frozen food
Pork
Restructured meat
Steak

6.6 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document have been marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content, as written, irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Preparid shall overlap not less
er the bag is folded down
Army ed in layers, with each
e layers of steaks shall
Projectess than 1 inch longer
ion, a sheet of
e bag and the first layer

arranged as specified in
hipping container which
on or Uniform Freight
the fiberboard boxes
PPP-B-636. Prior to
a polyethylene bag and
heets as specified in

roduct, packed as
it loads in accordance
fied. When unit loads
tallic strapping, except

cial marking required
s shall be marked in
ing precautionary marking
s, larger than other

ccordance with

pecify the following:

se 3.1, 4.4, and 6.3).
les (see 3.4.1 and 6.3).

lng is required (see 5.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

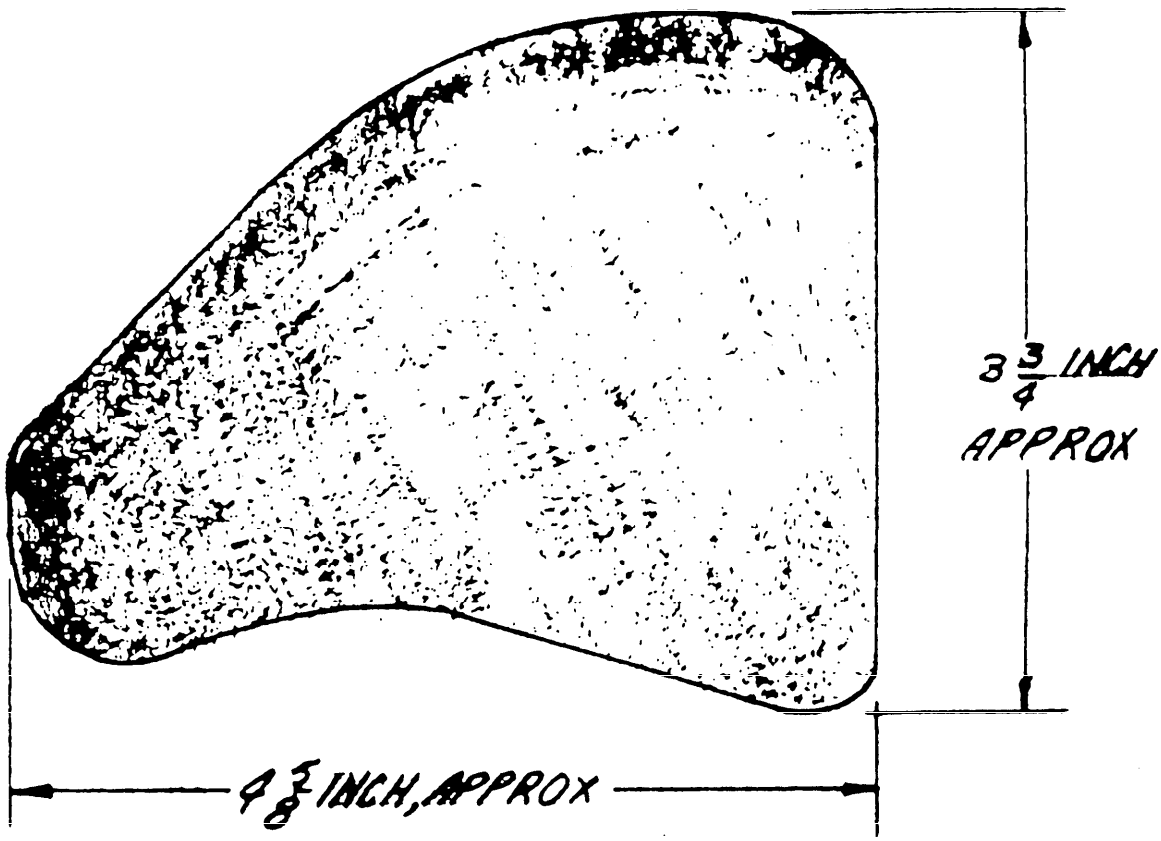


FIGURE 1. Pork steak, flaked, formed, breaded, frozen.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provid suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, an mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, w too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

US Army Natick Research, Development, and
Engineering Center
Natick, MA 01760-5014

NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300
STRNC-ES

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Commander
US Army Natick Research, Development,
and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Box 14A
Natick, MA 01760-5014

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-P-44131A	Pork Steak, Flaked, Formed, Breaded, Frozen

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

NATICK OP, 1 Apr 84

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:05Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.